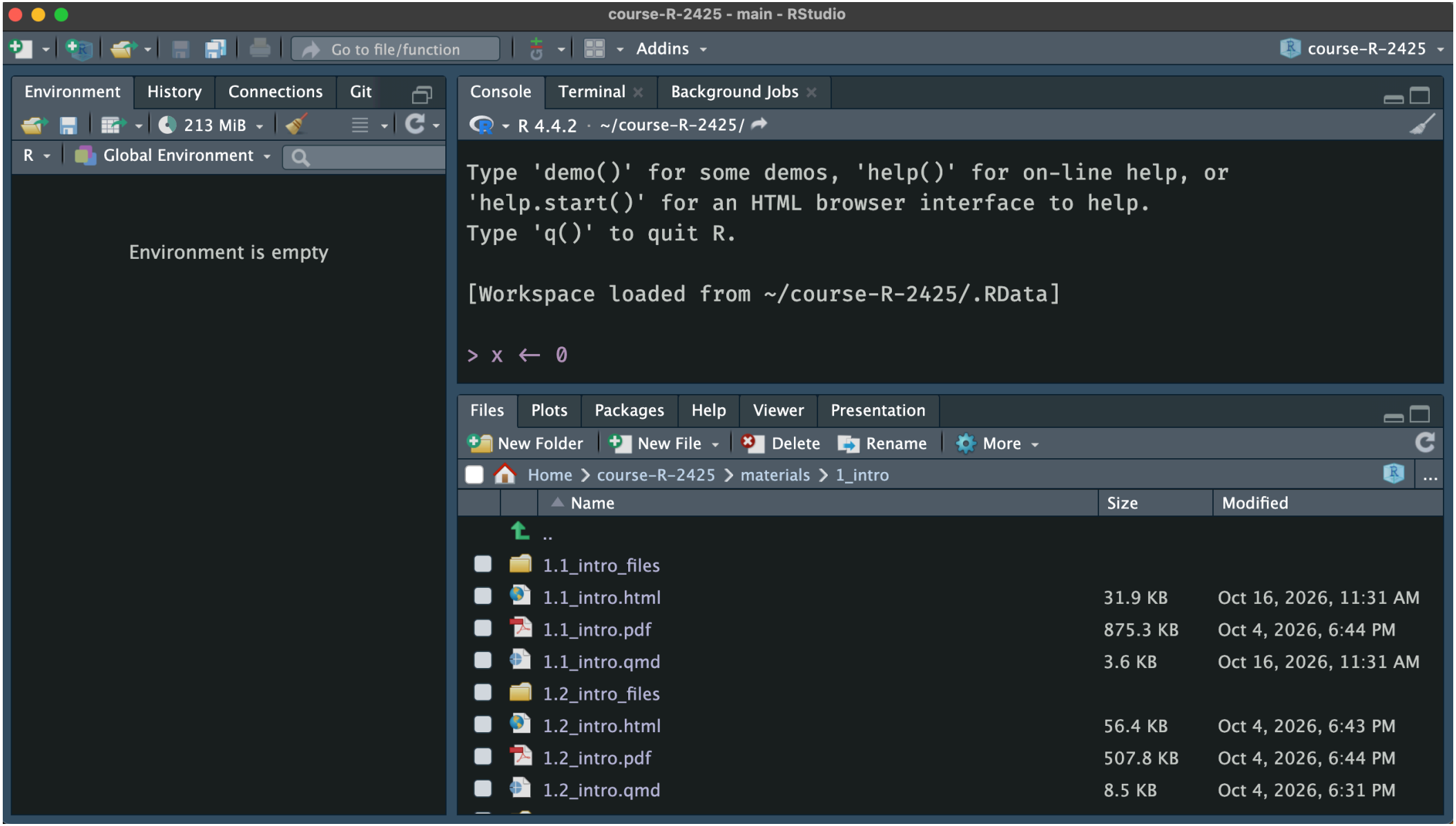
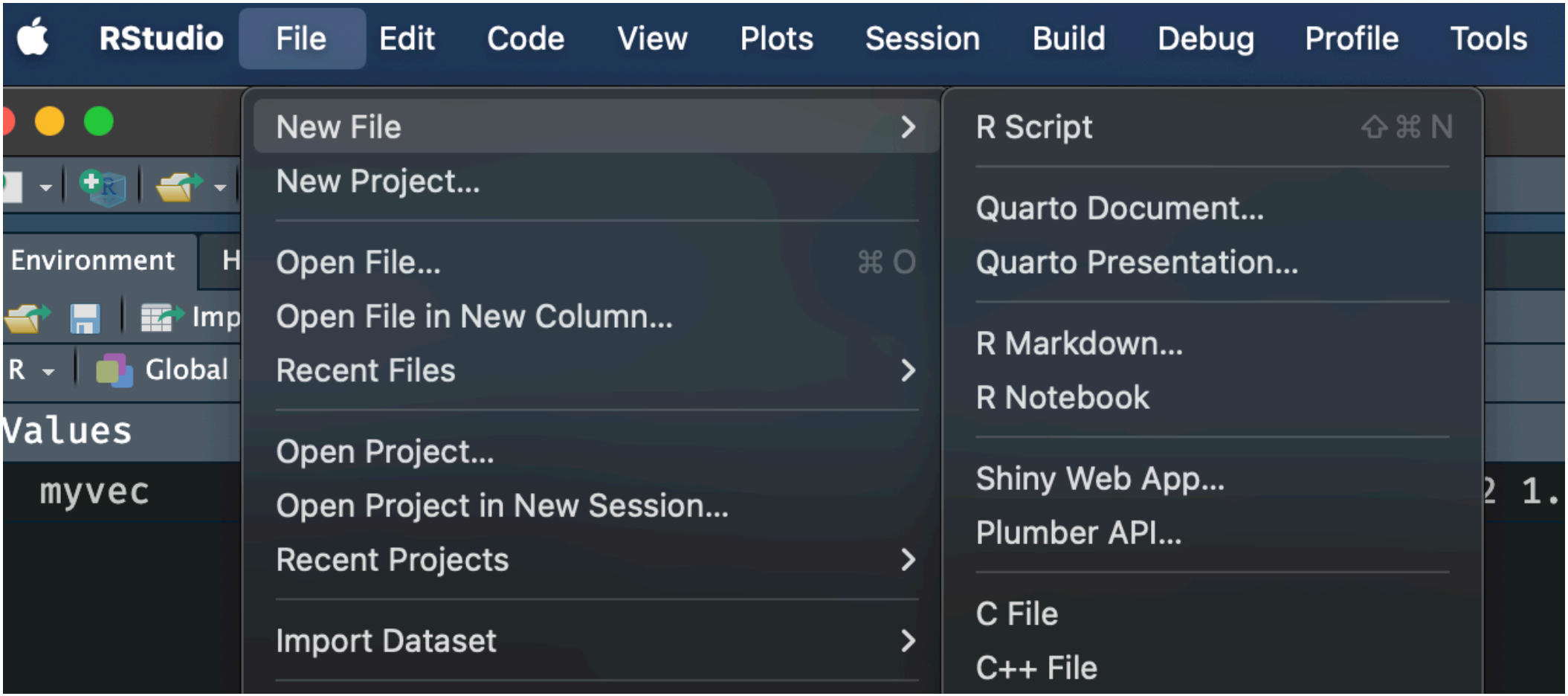
Introduction 1

RStudio


course-R-2425 - main - RStudio
Go to file/function
Addins
course-R-2425
Environment
History
Connections
Git
213 MiB
R
Global Environment
Environment is empty
Console
Terminal
Background Jobs
R 4.4.2 · ~/course-R-2425/
Type 'demo()' for some demos, 'help()' for on-line help, or
'help.start()' for an HTML browser interface to help.
Type 'q()' to quit R.
[Workspace loaded from ~/course-R-2425/.RData]
> x ← 0
Files
Plots
Packages
Help
Viewer
Presentation
New Folder
New File
Delete
Rename
More
Home > course-R-2425 > materials > 1_intro
Name
Size
Modified
..
1.1_intro_files
1.1_intro.html 31.9 KB Oct 16, 2026, 11:31 AM
1.1_intro.pdf 875.3 KB Oct 4, 2026, 6:44 PM
1.1_intro.qmd 3.6 KB Oct 16, 2026, 11:31 AM
1.2_intro_files
1.2_intro.html 56.4 KB Oct 4, 2026, 6:43 PM
1.2_intro.pdf 507.8 KB Oct 4, 2026, 6:44 PM
1.2_intro.qmd 8.5 KB Oct 4, 2026, 6:31 PM

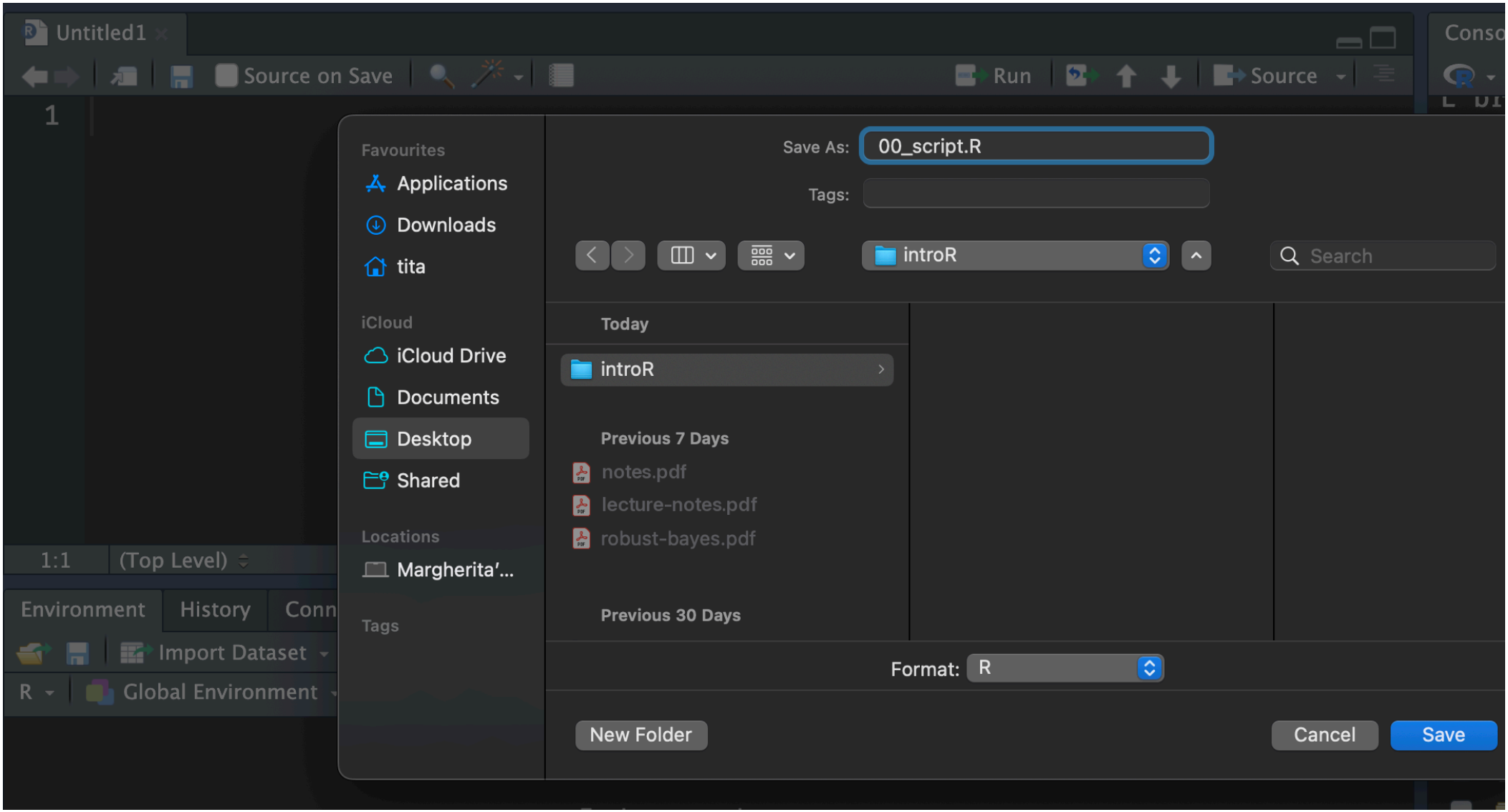
How to work in R

Let's create a **script**, a "text" file where you write and save your code.



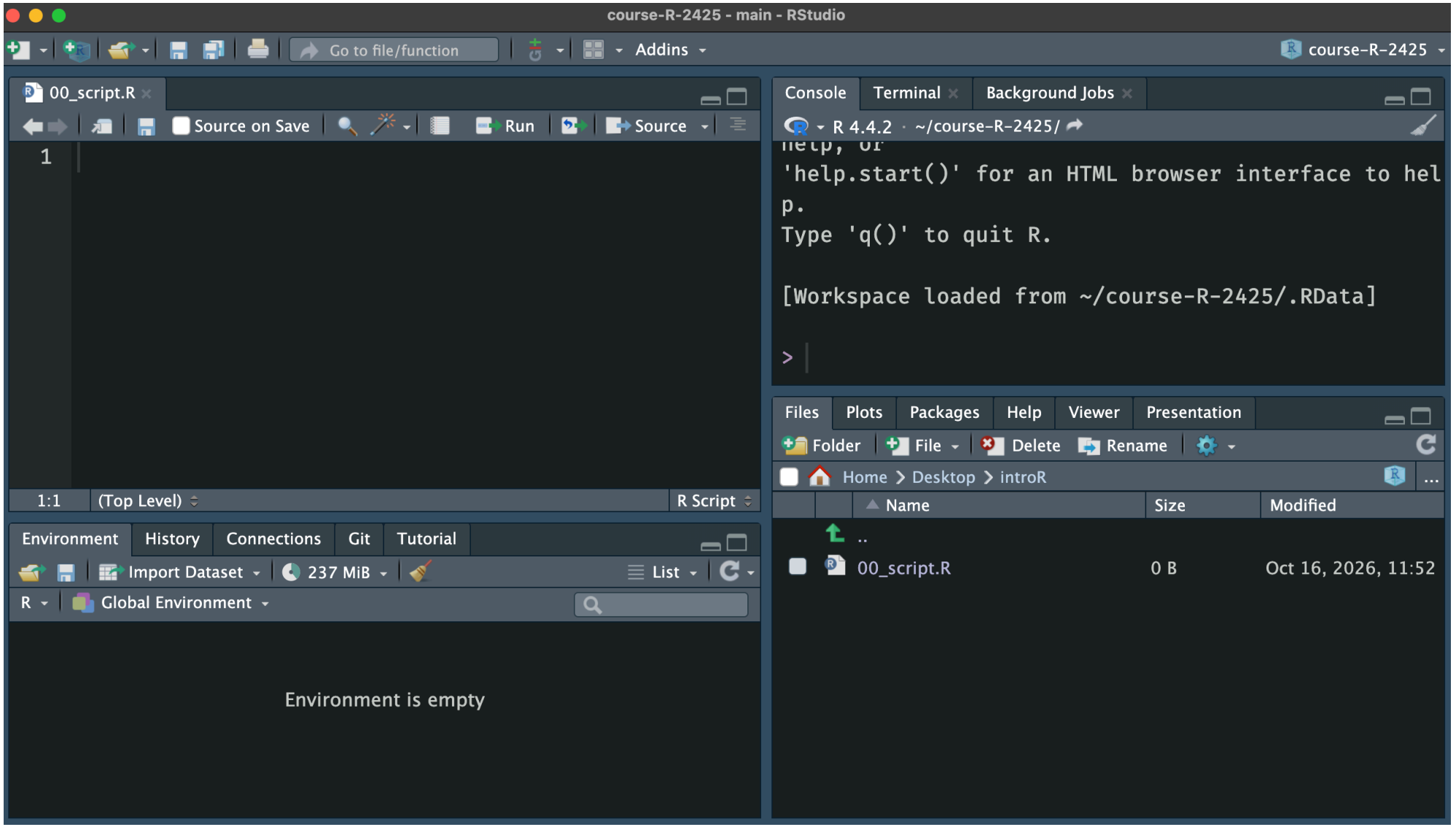
How to work in R

Let's save it:



Working Environment

RStudio is divided into **4 main panes**:



RStudio is divided into **4 main panes**:

- **Script.** The text file where you write and save your code. You can run one line at a time (`Ctrl + Enter` / `Cmd + Enter`) or the whole script by clicking `Source`. Comments are added with `#`.
- **Console.** This is where R runs the code and shows the results. You can type commands directly in the console for quick tests, but they are not saved.
- **Environment / Temporary desk.** Shows all the **objects** created during the current session.
- **Miscellaneous.** A multi-purpose pane with several tabs, including the file explorer.

Working Directory

The location (folder) on your PC where R is working and where R expects to find your files, unless specified otherwise.

```
1 getwd()
```

```
[1] "/Users/tita/course-R-2425/materials/1_intro"
```

Absolute Path

PC

```
|- Users
    |
    |- tita
        |
        |- course-R-2425
            |
            |- materials
                |
                |- 1_intro
```

I am working inside the 1_intro folder.

Relative Path (to the working directory)

1. Change the working directory with the `setwd` command:

```
setwd('/Users/tita/Desktop/introR')
```

2. Download the file prova.csv and put it in the folder.

3. Since we are working inside the folder, if we want to load a file located in this folder we can simply write the file name in quotes and use, for example, the `read.csv` function:

```
data <- read.csv("prova.csv")
```

Now move the `prova.csv` outside the introR folder (e.g., in the desktop), and run the same command..

```
data <- read.csv("prova.csv")
```

If we want to load a file located outside our `wd`, we need to refer to it through its absolute path:

```
data <- read.csv("/Users/tita/Desktop/prova.csv")
```

Or, first change the working directory with the `setwd` command and then load the file.

```
setwd('/Users/tita/Desktop')
data <- read.csv("prova.csv")
```

The best solution?

Create an R project!

- they set the working directory automatically
- they let you use ***relative paths*** instead of ***absolute paths***
- they give quick access to a given project

Let’s create one!